



Play ON!

2005 brings with it new games with eye-popping visuals, the associated computer upgrades, and the resulting disappearing bank accounts. We present a comprehensive test of 32 graphics cards to help you blow your money wisely

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Another year is upon us; the time to upgrade your computer is at hand. We could think of nothing better to start the upgrade cycle than a new video card. This cycle will probably be the last time you will need an AGP card. For one, you will definitely

upgrade to a DirectX 9-based card, which will be good for at least two more years, and by then, PCI-Express (PCI-X) cards would be common and ready to buy!

Of course, PCI-X has already made an appearance in our market, but the technology is still finding its feet. It will take PCI-X at least two more years to go mainstream from the niche it currently enjoys. Another point to note is the fact that games scheduled for release in the near

future will not be able to take advantage of a PCI-X solution. They will perform just as they would with an AGP card—making your investment in AGP now somewhat future-proof.

If you are a gamer who demands the latest and the greatest right now, you can opt for a high-end video card, which will serve you well for a while, ensuring that you do not need to change platforms for at least a while. However, if PCI-Express is what you are looking for, you will